

FX Technical Update

US dollar bear trend gains traction after key support breakdown

- EUR/USD bullishly pressures key retracement and pattern resistance that sits just below 1.06. We've expected the market to struggle with that resistance, but the probability for a further retracement of the Sep-Feb slide would increase if broader pro-cyclical market trends continue across other asset classes
- The cable breakout from a well-defined Dec-Feb base pattern threatens our view that the pair would struggle to sustain a rally through the 1.26 resistance area. For now, the bull trend stays in gear while above 1.2459-1.2554. Next major resistance sits at 1.2767-1.2811
- The USD/JPY slide overshot our expected support along with the move in 10-year JGBs, but the pair's tentative bounce from the 148.65-149.23 support layer triggered a momentum divergence buy signal. We think the market is set up for some mean reversion and consolidation
- USD/CNH triggers a tactical bullish momentum divergence signal as it bounces from support. We view that 7.2132-7.2346 area as a critical threshold on the chart as it defines the potential neckline of a near four month reversal pattern
- AUD/USD rallies into the 0.64-0.6414 resistance layer after breakout out from the Dec-Feb base pattern. Bulls have the agenda while above 0.6231-0.6331 support. Next resistance rests at 0.6515-0.652.

Technical Strategy

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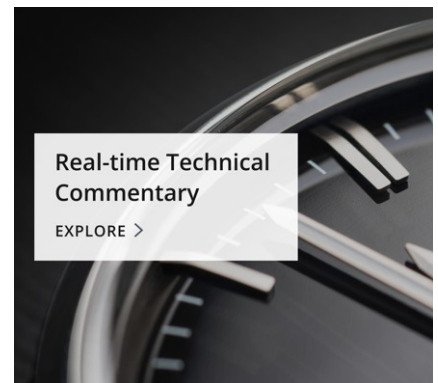
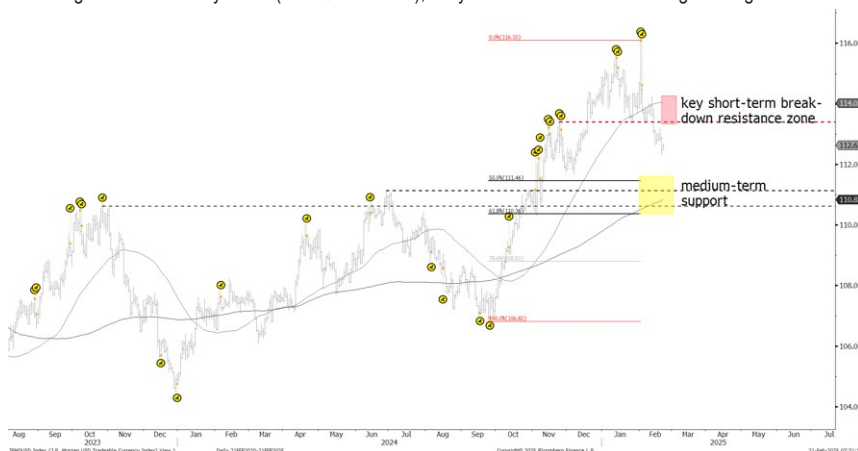


Figure 1: The US dollar short-term bear trend gains traction after the break below key pattern support. We believe bears keep the agenda while below the 50-day moving average and the trend can stretch to the 4Q24 range breakout area, roughly 1.5% below current levels.

J.P. Morgan USD Currency Index (JPMQUSD Index), daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

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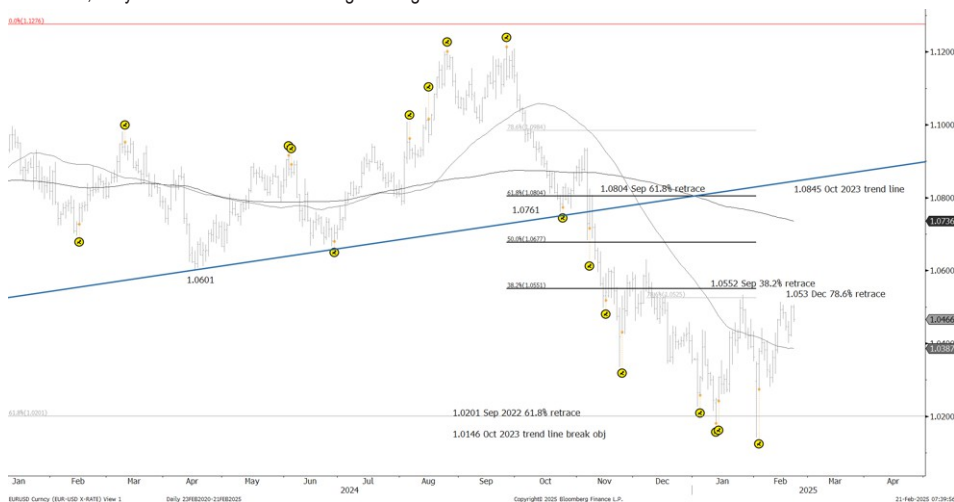
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EUR/USD bullishly pressures key pattern resistance

EUR/USD pressures resistance at the 1.053 Dec 78.6% retrace, 1.0533 Jan 27 high, and 1.0552 Sep 38.2% retrace following the early-Feb headline-driven whipsaw. That move retested the 1.0146-1.0201 medium-term support layer and triggered another momentum divergence buy signal. The Nov-Feb price action now looks like a potential base pattern on the heels of the impulsive slide from the 1.1214 Sep 25 high. It is worth noting that that general pattern is also present across a large array of cyclically sensitive markets across the asset classes. Those patterns formed as a US exceptionalism became a consensus outlook, sentiment measures reached into extreme territory, and in the context of a two-year period of lackluster global manufacturing performance. While it is hard to have a high conviction medium-term outlook given the uncertain path of policy, we've suggested responding to pattern breakouts and trailing stops to manage that risk. EUR/USD has not yet broken through the key inflection near 1.06 and is lagging correlated markets that have already moved through similar thresholds. Please see our global equity update [here](#) that shows a number of those markets, and AUD/USD below. For EUR/USD specifically, keep a tactical bullish bias while above the 1.0387 50-day moving average and 1.028 Feb 10 low. An upside break would turn our attention to the 1.0736 200-day moving average, 1.0804 Sep 61.8% retrace, and 1.0845 Oct 2023 internal trend line.

Figure 2: EUR/USD bullishly pressures key retracement and pattern resistance that sits just below 1.06. We've expected the market to struggle with that resistance, but the probability for a further retracement of the Sep-Feb slide would increase if broader pro-cyclical market trends continue across other asset classes.

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



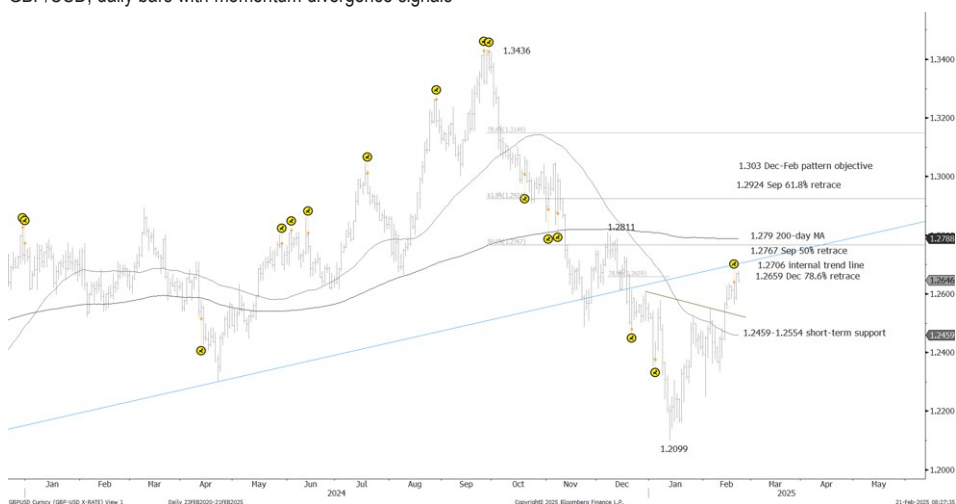
Source: J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

GBP/USD presses deeper into resistance near 1.26 and trades above a clear base breakout

Cable's breakout from a well-defined bottom pattern formation threatens our view that the pair would struggle to sustain a rally through resistance clustered near 1.26. While we haven't thrown in the towel on that base-case view, we recognize it remains at material risk as long as the pair trades above 1.2459-1.2554 breakout and 50-day moving average support and until a clear downside reversal pattern sets up near our favored resistance levels (Figure 3). The next major zone of resistance includes the 1.5767 Sep 50% retrace, 1.279 200-day moving average, and 1.2811 Dec rebound high. Medium-term levels sit up at the 1.2924 Sep 61.8% retrace and 1.303 Dec-Feb pattern objective.

Figure 3: The cable breakout from a well-defined Dec-Feb base pattern threatens our view that the pair would struggle to sustain a rally through the 1.26 resistance area. For now, the bull trend stays in gear while above 1.2459-1.2554. Next major resistance sits at 1.2767-1.2811.

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



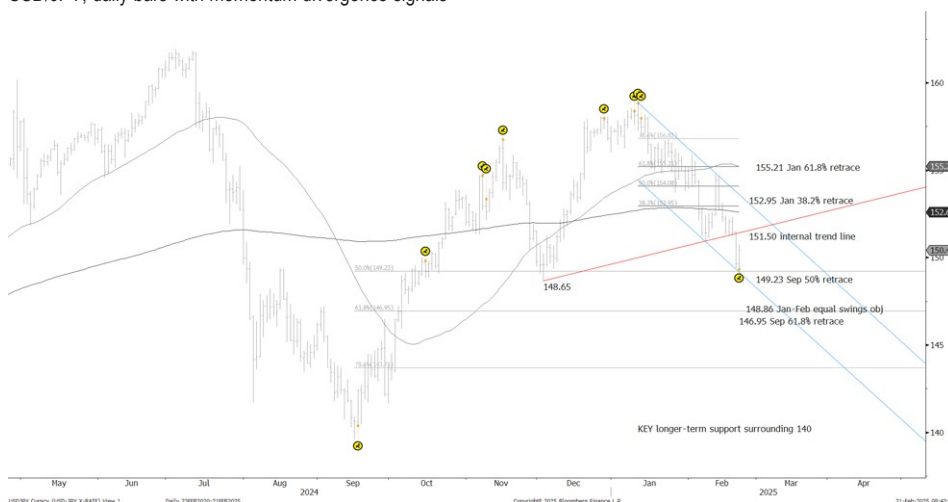
Source: J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

USD/JPY triggers tactical buy signal as it bounces from 148.65-149.23 support

The **USD/JPY** slide from the 158.87 Jan peak overshoot our favored downside targets and most recently extended to the 149.23 Sep 50% retrace and 148.65 Dec low (Figure 4). At the same time, 10-year JGBs cheapened through our favored bear targets for 1Q25, that sat near 1.30%. Despite those overshoots, we suspect both markets can see some backing and filling, and the tentative momentum divergence buy signal that triggered on the USJPY chart marks the first sign that our view is getting some traction. A push back above the 151.50 Dec-Feb trend line would confirm a short-term low and set the market up for a test of the two main resistance layers overhead. The first includes the 152.61 200-day moving average and 152.95 Jan 38.2% retrace. The second is defined by the 155.21-155.22 50-day moving average and 61.8% retrace. We suspect a mean reversion to higher levels will falter at one of those two zones and leave the pair trading in the middle of the Nov-Feb range. Alternatively, next support sits at the 148.86 Jan-Feb equal swings objective and 146.95 Sep 61.8% retrace.

Figure 4: The USD/JPY slide overshoot our expected support along with the move in 10-year JGBs, but the pair's tentative bounce from the 148.65-149.23 support layer triggered a momentum divergence buy signal. We think the market is set up for some mean reversion and consolidation.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



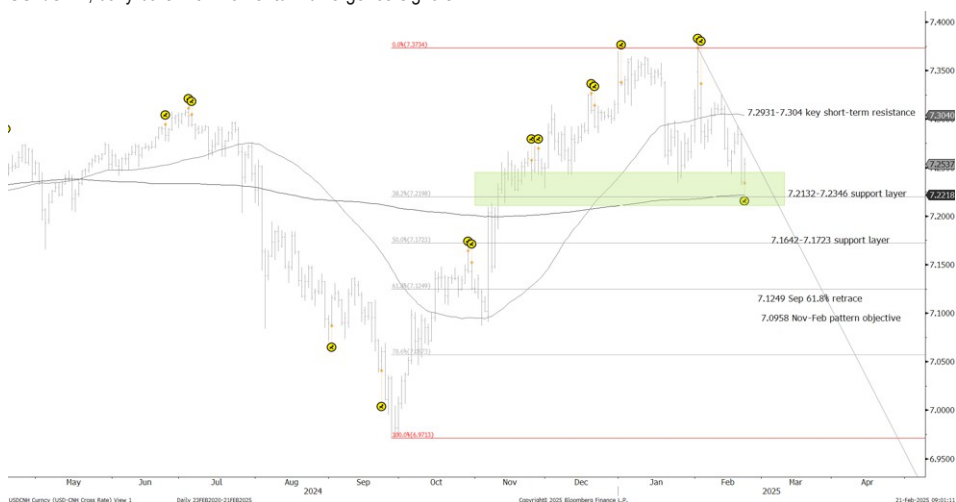
Source: J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

USD/CNH pressures key chart pattern support

Similar to USD/JPY, USD/CNH triggers a short-term buy signal as the pair tries to stabilize at 7.2132-7.2346 support (Figure 5). That support includes the 200-day moving average, the Sep 38.2% retrace, and marks the lower-end of what looks like a near four month bearish reversal pattern. While we suspect the pair can see some near-term backing and filling, the developing trend bias stays negative while below the 7.2931-7.305 Feb 19 high and 50-day moving average. We would view a break below that support cluster as a major signal. Initial breakdown support rests at 7.1642-7.1723 and then the 7.1249 Sep 61.8% retrace and 7.0958 Nov-Feb pattern objective. That is also the area that the market released higher in 4Q24 from the Sep-Oct base pattern. On the upside, the Nov-Feb pattern developed below the 7.3682-7.3789 Oct 2022-Sep 2023 highs, the highest levels USD/CNH-USD/CNY has traded at since before the GFC-era. Given the current policy risks, we would see a break to the topside as an equally impactful event, and one that could potentially see material follow through.

Figure 5: USD/CNH triggers a tactical bullish momentum divergence signal as it bounces from support. We view that 7.2132-7.2346 area as a critical threshold on the chart as it defines the potential neckline of a near four month reversal pattern.

USD/CNH, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



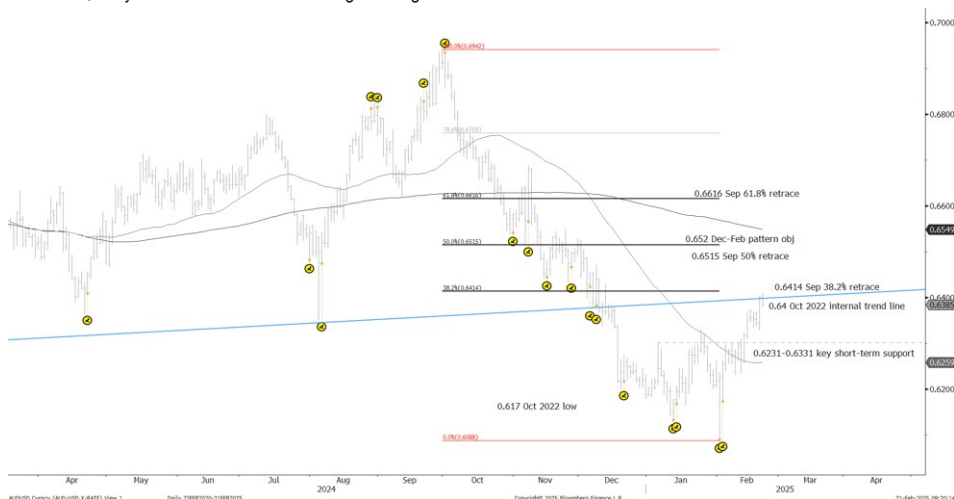
Source: J.P. Morgan. Bloomberg Finance L.P.

AUD/USD makes some progress after breaking through base pattern resistance

In our view, **AUD/USD** bulls have the agenda after the Dec-Feb base pattern breakout and as long as subsequent setbacks hold above the 0.6231-0.6331 support zone (Figure 6). That zone includes the 50-day moving average, the levels that roughly marked the base pattern resistance zone, and recent chart pivots. The rally has already achieved the 0.64 Oct 2022 internal trend line and 0.6414 Sep 38.2% retrace. That also roughly coincides with the 2024 range lows. A sustained break above that area would cement a broader trend reversal in our view and likely bring in additional momentum buying. Next resistance rests at the 0.6515 Sep 50% retrace, 0.652 Dec-Feb pattern objective, and 0.6549 200-day moving average. Other medium-term resistance includes the 0.6616 Sep 61.8% retrace. On the downside, the Dec-Feb pattern developed around the 0.617 Oct 2022 low.

Figure 6: AUD/USD rallies into the 0.64-0.6414 resistance layer after breakout out from the Dec-Feb base pattern. Bulls have the agenda while above 0.6231-0.6331 support. Next resistance rests at 0.6515-0.652.

AUD/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

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